

Towards Self-Understanding

A practical paper with no written examination. You are assessed on what you write, on the workshops you attend, on the seminars you argue in, and on the life-skills sessions you run with children.

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ASSESSMENT	WRITTEN PAPER	CREDITS	PERIODS / WEEK
Internal only — 50 marks	None	2	2 consecutive

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UNIT 1

Writing Tasks — Any Five ($5 \times 3 = 15$)

The syllabus lists **ten** writing tasks. The mentor or the team of faculties distributes five of them to the student-teachers, keeping all ten in view, and gives outline or theoretical knowledge on the tasks before assigning them. Marks are awarded on the basis of the decision taken by the team of faculties. All ten are set out here, because the five you receive are chosen for you.

TABLE 1.1 — THE TEN WRITING TASKS, THEIR FORM AND THEIR MARKING

#	Syllabus task	What you submit	What the marker looks for
1	Monthly creative writing on classroom experience, observation of a life situation, ideas and issues	Diary-type entry, under 300 words, once a month	A selected moment with names, words and sequence — not a generalisation about the month
2	Script on personal and social values (honesty, courage, co-operation, respect) for performance as role-play	Stage script: 4–6 minutes, 2–4 actors, stage directions, no-cost setting	The value <i>shown</i> under pressure, with a cost to pay; a discussion question, not a moral
3	Article on self-understanding as the ability to understand one's own thoughts and actions	Article, 500–700 words	A defensible definition; the gap between thought and action; consequence in a classroom
4	Article on peace and stress management for harmonious development of the self	Article plus a personal stress-management plan	Workable techniques rather than slogans; an honest account of your own stressors
5	Case study on personal and professional growth, as an example of understanding self	Case study: background, problem, evidence, intervention, outcome, learning	Problem stated as a behaviour; at least one change that did <i>not</i> work
6	Article on appreciation from others for enhancing self-understanding	Article built on 2–3 concrete instances	How one specific remark changed one specific behaviour; the others treated with dignity

#	Syllabus task	What you submit	What the marker looks for
7	A significant experience or event of life (good or bad) and its outcome — introspective report	Structured first-person report, 600–800 words	Candour about your own part; the event written before its meaning
8	“Understanding oneself is power” — explained with real-life examples	Article with at least three worked examples	Range of examples; a defensible close on the limits of the claim
9	Life history of spiritual leaders / educational reformers, special reference to Assam	Sourced biographical sketch, 800 words, using the five-part frame	Accuracy of fact and of works; the self-discipline the work demanded
10	Qualities of a teacher leading to school and leadership style, with examples	Analytical essay with classroom examples	Each quality tied to observable behaviour and to a leadership consequence

KEY IDEA

The ten tasks are not ten of the same thing. Tasks 1 and 7 are creative and reflective, judged on honesty and on the selection of a significant moment. Task 2 is a performance text, judged on whether the value appears under pressure. Tasks 3, 4, 6 and 8 are articles, judged on argument and example. Task 5 is a case study, judged on analysis. Task 9 is a documented life history, judged on accuracy. Task 10 is analytical, judged on whether qualities are tied to behaviour. Writing to the wrong standard is the commonest way to lose the three marks available on a task.

● 1.1 Writing Task 1 — Monthly Creative Writing on Classroom Experience and Life Situations

Write every month on your classroom experience, on an observed life situation, and on the ideas and issues arising from them, to develop capacity for reflection. This is the spine of the paper; the other nine tasks are amplifications of it. A month of teaching is two hundred small experiences, and the skill being built is **selection** — noticing which forty seconds carried the meaning.

A good entry opens with a time, a place and a person, then moves from what happened to what it meant. Situations outside school count: a queue at a ration shop, a neighbour’s illness, a festival watched from a balcony. Keep entries under 300 words, write on the day if you can, and end with one line beginning “I did not notice that...” — the omitted observation is usually the more useful half.

● 1.2 Writing Task 2 — Script on Personal and Social Values, for Performance as Role-Play

Write a script on personal and social values — honesty, courage, co-operation and respect among them — that *may be performed* as a role-play. The operative word is *may*: a script read aloud and never staged has failed the task. A play about honesty is worthless if honesty is merely announced. Put the honest character something to lose, give the dishonest character a reason the audience will half-believe, and let the cost of the dishonest choice fall on someone else in the scene. Keep the language of the classroom; in a multilingual Assamese-medium school a script that moves between languages is realistic. End with a discussion question, not a moral.

TABLE 1.2 — FOUR VALUES AND FOUR DRAMATIZABLE DILEMMAS

Value	A situation with a real cost	What the role-play teaches
Honesty	A child finds a lost purse near the school ground; the teacher's own relative is suspected of having taken it	Whose trust is harder to keep — the group's or the individual's
Courage	A student-teacher must report a rule-breaking by a senior colleague, in front of the head teacher	Reporting without aggression or humiliation
Co-operation	A group presentation collapses because one member does no work; the deadline is fixed	Complaining, confronting, negotiating — three strategies, three outcomes
Respect	A child with a speech difficulty is asked to read aloud in front of the class	Respect for the person against respect for the rule of turn-taking

● 1.3 Writing Task 3 — Article on Self-Understanding as Understanding One's Own Thoughts and Actions

The syllabus supplies the definition to build on: self-understanding is *the ability to understand one's own thoughts and actions*. The phrase does two pieces of work. **Thoughts** covers the internal half — beliefs, assumptions, expectations, the stories one tells oneself about people. **Actions** covers the external half — what one says and does, including what one does without noticing. An article of this kind should move from definition to mechanism to consequence.

In most adults thought and action come apart, and the gap is where difficulty lies: a person sincerely holds a value and acts against it under pressure. What closes the gap is noticing, made regular by journal writing, honest feedback and the Johari Window. Then give consequences in both directions — without self-understanding a teacher mistakes a child's withdrawal for indifference and escalates; with it, the same teacher asks a second question. Close on a defensible claim: self-understanding is necessary but not sufficient, because insight without technique stays private.

COMMON MISTAKE

Do not define self-understanding as loving yourself, or as feeling good about yourself. That is a mood; understanding is a capacity. Define it as *accurate knowledge of one's own thoughts, feelings, motives and patterns of action, together with the ability to report them honestly*, and the rest of the article follows from the definition.

● 1.4 Writing Task 4 — Article on Peace and Stress Management

The syllabus holds two ideas together deliberately: **peace** and **stress management**, both directed at the harmonious development of the self. Inner peace is not the absence of stress; it is the capacity to remain functional, fair and kind while under stress. Structure the article around three questions. *What is stress?* The body's and mind's response to a demand perceived as exceeding current resources — and the perception is the operative part, since the same deadline energises one student-teacher and crushes another.

What are the sources? For a D.El.Ed. student-teacher: performance anxiety in a demonstration lesson, comparison with peers, uncertainty about placement and

examinations, workload, family expectation, financial strain, and difficulty speaking one's home language in the institution. Being specific about your own stressors is half the article. *What can be done?* Techniques, not slogans.

TABLE 1.3 — STRESS MANAGEMENT TECHNIQUES A STUDENT-TEACHER CAN PRACTISE

Family	Technique	How to do it
Body	Slower breathing	Six breaths per minute for two minutes before a class, longer exhale than inhale
Body	Release after load	A brief walk or stretch between periods, and a real lunch break away from the classroom
Mind	Naming the thought	Label it as a prediction (“they will think I am unprepared”) rather than as a fact
Mind	Reframing	Ask what the anxiety is protecting; fear of a poor evaluation often improves preparation
Time	Listing and prioritising	All deadlines in one place, ranked by consequence, not by how loudly they complain
Social	Asking for help	Name the specific help required to a specific person
Social	Peer debriefing	Ten minutes with a peer after a difficult session, structured by three questions
Meaning	Reconnection to purpose	Recall one child who was helped because of what was being done

● 1.5 Writing Task 5 — Case Study on Personal and Professional Growth

The case is not the point; the case is the evidence. You are showing that you can study one stretch of your own conduct closely enough to see the pattern inside it, and that a change in behaviour followed. Use the standard sequence. **Background** — the situation, with the context that makes it intelligible. **Problem** — stated as a behaviour, not a feeling: “I answered the child before he had finished”, not “I was impatient”. **Evidence** — what happened, and what others observed.

Intervention — what you actually changed, step by step. **Outcome** — with evidence, honestly stated if the evidence is thin. **Learning** — the generalisable insight, stated as a class of situations and not one incident. Include at least one instance where the intervention *did not* work: a case in which everything improved on the first attempt reads as reconstruction rather than research, and self-understanding includes knowing the limits of one's own successes.

● 1.6 Writing Task 6 — Article on Appreciation from Others

This task inverts the usual direction of attention: you write about the ways other people have noticed something about you, and how that appreciation feeds self-understanding. A remark from another person is often the only mirror that shows a part of oneself that one's own looking-glass cannot display — precisely the blind spot of the Johari Window. Treat three things. *How appreciation works*: it is not flattery, which is indiscriminate; it is specific, based on observation, and costs the speaker something.

“When you corrected Rahim in front of the class he stopped coming, so now I tell him privately and he comes back” carries information; “you are a good teacher” carries almost none. *How it can be received badly* — a compliment that seems to carry an expectation, praise a person feels is misplaced, feedback mistaken for criticism. *How to seek it usefully* — ask a specific, answerable question (“what should I stop

doing in class?") rather than an open invitation. Ground the article in two or three named sources, and write about the others with care.

● 1.7 Writing Task 7 — Introspective Report on a Significant Life Event

Take a significant experience or event of your life — the syllabus says explicitly *good or bad* — note its outcome, and write an introspective report. The difference between an anecdote and an introspective report is the whole task: an anecdote narrates, an introspective report examines your own part in what happened — what you thought, felt, wanted, did, would do differently, and now believe. The event need not be dramatic; the requirement is significance *to you*. Write the event first, as it happened, without evaluating it, and only then write what it meant — students who reverse this order produce justification instead of reflection.

REFLECTION

If the event was bad, do not spend the report on blame. Blame is externalised self-knowledge and teaches nothing. Name your own decisions, your own part and your own omission, accurately and without theatre, then state what you now do differently. If the event was good, be equally careful: the growth lies in identifying which of your own actions contributed to it, because only those can be repeated.

● 1.8 Writing Task 8 — “Understanding Oneself is Power”, with Examples

Take the claim seriously rather than asserting it. Begin by being precise about **power**: not authority over others, but *capacitance* — the ability to choose one’s response, to act from intention rather than impulse, and to influence a situation because one understands the forces in it. Then argue in three movements. *Power over oneself*: the gap between stimulus and response. A child is disrespectful; there is a choice in what happens next, and its size is a function of self-understanding.

Power in relationships: self-understanding makes accurate listening possible, because you can hear what a child says without the interference of your own unfinished business, and it makes a person coachable. *Power in decision and leadership*: a person who has examined their motives can be trusted, and trust is the currency of every group. Close honestly: insight not followed by practice remains insight, and real power shows up in what is done for others.

TABLE 1.4 — WHERE SELF-UNDERSTANDING SHOWS UP AS POWER

Domain	What it makes possible	Shape of the example
Self-management	A usable pause between stimulus and response	Not shouting at the child who has just overturned the inkpot, when shouting was the response three weeks ago
Relationship	Accurate listening without self-projection	Hearing that “I didn’t understand” is a statement about the explanation, not about the child
Teaching	Adjusting to the child rather than insisting on the plan	Abandoning a prepared demonstration lesson when the class will not engage
Ethics	Seeing one’s own motive where it is being denied	Noticing that “honest feedback” to a colleague was partly rivalry
Leadership	Distinguishing conviction from defensiveness	Holding a position while remaining genuinely open to evidence against it

● 1.9 Writing Task 9 — Life History of Spiritual Leaders and Educational Reformers, with Special Reference to Assam

Write the life history of a spiritual leader or educational reformer, with special reference to Assam, *as a real-life example of understanding self*. The closing clause tells you what the life history is for: you are not writing a biography, you are writing a biography about the inner discipline — what the person had to master within themselves before they could do what they did outside themselves.

Use the five-part frame in Table 1.5, and be careful with sources: use reliable secondary accounts and standard reference works for dates and events. Do not attribute a specific quotation to any of these figures unless you can locate it in a reliable printed source — a fabricated quotation is the commonest error in this task. Where you are unsure of a detail, write generally.

TABLE 1.5 — THE FIVE-PART FRAME FOR A LIFE HISTORY

Section	What to include	Warning
Context	Period, region, social and political conditions, the educational system then existing	Do not project today’s schools or laws backwards
The person	Family background, early education, influences, language and tradition	Keep to what is documented; generalise rather than invent
Turning point	One event or decision that changed the direction of the life	Do not manufacture a dramatic moment if none is recorded
Public work	What was written, taught, composed or reformed; where and for whom	Be specific about works and their titles
Self-discipline	The inner capacity the work required, and the cost sustained	This is the analytical section; do not let it collapse into praise

● 1.10 Assamese Spiritual Leaders and Educational Reformers — a Working Reference for Task 9

The entries below are deliberately short and general: starting points for your own reading, not finished essays. Each is set against one question only — *what did this person have to understand about the self in order to do what they did?* Where a date is

given, it is one generally agreed upon; where detail is disputed or obscure, the entry says only what can be said safely. Three sketches — one from the devotional tradition, two from the educational-reform tradition — usually earn more than a dozen figures done in a hurry.

TABLE 1.6 — ASSAMESE FIGURES FOR THE LIFE-HISTORY TASK

Figure	Period and what is documented	The self-discipline the work implies
Srimanta Sankardeva	1445–1568. Central figure of the Vaishnavite tradition in Assam, established through repeated political upheaval; <i>Giti Giti</i> is among the earliest surviving Assamese works, and the <i>Borgeet</i> devotional song tradition is associated with him	Disciplined repetition — set times, sustained practice, one's own mood submitted to a larger order — kept over decades and not for applause
Madhavdeva	1484–1564. Carried the tradition forward and gave it its most widely influential verse; the <i>Borgeet</i> attributed to him is still sung in Assamese households, its subject matter the moral life told through the crow, the crane, the deer and the farmer	Humility — seeing the human in the nearest creature, which is close to what a teacher is asked to practise
Madhav Kandali	Fourteenth century, generally placed in the first half. The earliest major Assamese translator, credited with an Assamese <i>Ramayana</i> in prose and verse that became the base text of the Assamese Ramayana tradition	Precision and patience — knowing a text in one language well enough to say it in another
Chandraprabha Saonian	Early seventeenth century. A major Vaishnavite saint-poet of the later phase, known for the <i>Kirtan Ghosa</i> collection	Renewing an earlier discipline after a period of decline, through sustained writing and travel
Srimanta Chaitanya Deva	Sixteenth century. The Vaishnavite saint after whom the set of six traditional associates, or <i>kantas</i> , are named	Companionship in practice — the ideal was a group bound by common discipline, not a solitary individual
Hemchandra Goswami; Gauri Shankar Heera; Krishnaram Bhattacharya	Three saint-poets and scholars of the sixteenth to eighteenth centuries, associated with early Assamese devotional writing, the preservation of devotional song in the later tradition, and Assamese renderings and retellings of the <i>Ramayana</i> respectively	Keep the treatment general and let the self-discipline section carry the analysis — that is where the marks are, and it can be written accurately without entering disputed detail
G. Sankara Kurup	1861–1941. In 1883 established at Nagaon the first Assamese-medium school; the administrative discouragement and the years of persistence before the system took root are unusually well documented	That a small thing kept is larger than a large thing abandoned, and that the judgement of powerful people is not the outcome of a project
Hafiz Alam	The administrator associated with the resistance to the Nagaon school, remembered as the official who tried to obstruct it	Worth writing about because it asks what an official believed they were doing, and how a well-intentioned person can be sincerely mistaken about merit
Radhakishore Agarwala	Early twentieth-century Assamese essayist, teacher and public intellectual, closely associated with the movement for the cultivation and recognition of the Assamese language and with the Assam Sahitya Sabha	The discipline of a campaigner who must persuade people whose interests the status quo served, and so must understand motives that are not their own
Raghunath Chaudhuri	A Bengali intellectual who came to Assam and worked there for many years; investigated and wrote about the psychology of memory, and became associated with the practical teaching of memory and learning in Assamese-medium schools	Joining a rigorous interest in how memory and learning actually work with the conviction that it belongs in ordinary schools, not a laboratory

● 1.11 Writing Task 10 — Qualities of a Teacher and Leadership Style

Two distinctions keep this essay on track. The first is between a *quality* and a *behaviour*: “is compassionate” is a quality, “answers a child’s question before the child loses interest” is a behaviour, and only the second can be taught, observed or improved. The second is between a *teacher* and a *leader*: a teacher is judged largely by what happens in the classroom, a leader by what happens to the institution and the people in it. A teacher can be excellent and still not be a leader. Subject knowledge is necessary and not sufficient; the qualities that discriminate here are humility before evidence, emotional steadiness, procedural fairness, capacity for delegation, collegiality and accountability.

TABLE 1.7 — FROM QUALITY TO BEHAVIOUR TO LEADERSHIP CONSEQUENCE

Quality	Observable behaviour	Leadership consequence
Humility before evidence	Revises a lesson plan when the class shows it did not work, and records why	Creates a culture in which staff and children may report problems without fear
Emotional steadiness	Does not take a child’s misbehaviour personally; lowers own voice rather than raising it	Reduces escalation; the staff room does not polarise
Procedural fairness	Same consequence for the same act, whichever child committed it	Establishes trust; reduces favouritism allegations and improves attendance
Delegation	Entrusts a task with the authority to complete it, and does not take it back	Builds capable colleagues; reduces single-point dependency
Collegiality	Observes a colleague’s class, discusses, and adapts rather than copies	Turns individual skill into institutional capacity
Accountability	Reports an incident to the head teacher the same day, including one’s own part	Makes the institution learnable from error

● 1.12 Journal and Report Templates

Between them the ten tasks form a **portfolio**, and its value lies in the pattern that becomes visible across entries, which no single task can show. Use one sheet per month, and keep the file so that you can read January next to April.

TABLE 1.8 — MONTHLY REFLECTION SHEET (ONE PER MONTH)

Field	What to write
1. Date and context	Where, when, with whom, what the situation was (one line)
2. The observed moment	One concrete incident in 100–200 words — words, actions, sequence, no interpretation yet
3. What I felt	Name the emotion specifically and rate it 1–5
4. What I did next	Your actual response, as a sequence of actions
5. What I did not notice at the time	Information that was available to you and that you used late or not at all
6. Pattern check	Is this the third or fourth time this month? Name the habit, not the instance
7. What helped	A person, a habit, a phrase, a rule you had set for yourself
8. One change to try	A single, specific, observable behavioural change for next month

Field	What to write
9. The value at stake, and the feedback pending	Which of honesty, courage, co-operation, respect was in play; and the exact question you will put to the mentor, a peer or the head teacher

Introspective report template — for Writing Task 7

- Title** and a one-sentence statement of the event in neutral terms.
- The event**, in time order, 300–500 words, as if reporting to someone who was not present. No interpretation in this section.
- The outcome**, including any consequences that were delayed or permanent.
- My part** — my decisions, my omissions, my motives. First person, without softening and without blame.
- What I felt at the time** and **what I feel now**, separately, with the difference explained.
- What I would do differently** — specific, behavioural, at least three items.
- The general lesson**, stated so that it applies to a class of situations.
- What remains unresolved** — an honest statement of what you still do not know.

Workshop and seminar reflection log

For every workshop and seminar, record four lines: the objective of the session; the one idea you took from it; the point at which you disagreed, and with whom; and the one action arising from it. The fourth line is the one a faculty panel cares about at the viva, and the one students forget.

● 1.13 How the Writing Portfolio Is Assessed

Marks are awarded by the team of faculties on the basis of their decision, guided by the ten tasks. The rubric below is a working model of what the three marks per task can reasonably distinguish between. It is a study aid, not an official marking scheme.

TABLE 1.9 — WORKING RUBRIC FOR A WRITING TASK (3 MARKS)		
Criterion	A strong response	Weak indicator
Observation / evidence	Concrete detail — names, words spoken, actions, numbers where possible	Generalisation: “the children were active”
Self-honesty	Owens its own part, including after a bad outcome	Blame located entirely in circumstances or others
Structure	A discernible shape: position, evidence, development, conclusion	An account with no line of argument
Reflection	Extracts a generalisable insight and states what will now be done	Insight stays at “I learnt a lot”
Language and presentation	Clear, economical, few grammatical slips	Repetition, imprecision, unpunctuated long sentences

TABLE 1.10 — MARKS STRUCTURE OF UNIT 1

Component	Number attempted	Marks each	Total
Writing tasks from the list of ten	5 (assigned by the mentor)	3	15
Monthly journal / reflection entries	Continuous across the semester	Raw material for the assigned tasks	—

UNIT 1 QUICK REVIEW

KEY POINTS

- ▶ Ten tasks are listed; the mentor distributes five; each carries 3 marks; the unit totals 15. The mentor gives outline or theoretical input *before* assignment, and awards the marks.
- ▶ Tasks 1 and 7 are judged on honesty and on the selection of a significant moment; 3, 4, 6 and 8 on argument and example; 2 on whether the value appears under pressure; 5 on analysis; 9 on accuracy and self-discipline; 10 on qualities tied to behaviour.
- ▶ Task 9 requires special reference to Assam; Task 7 explicitly accepts a bad event, and the interesting material is usually the bad one.
- ▶ Write events before meanings, and never attribute a quotation to a historical figure unless you can locate it in a reliable printed source.

KEY TERMS

Creative writing · **Introspective report** · **Case study** · **Script / role-play** · **Value** (a principle that guides conduct and can be tested against a choice) · **Self-understanding** (the ability to understand one's own thoughts and actions) · **Leadership style** · **Portfolio** · **Vaishnavite tradition of Assam** · **Borgeet** · **Giti Giti**

UNIT 2

Workshop — First Compulsory, Plus Any Two ($3 \times 5 = 15$)

Six workshops are listed. The first — Understanding Self and SWOT Analysis — is compulsory; the student-teacher chooses two more. Each carries 5 marks. The mentor or team of faculties gives detailed instructions on the topics and selects them; the workshop is followed by meaningful discussion and interaction with the intention of eliciting better experiential learning; and marks are awarded on the basis of reports in which the student-teacher reflects on their own critical thinking. A workshop report is therefore not a record of what was said. It is a record of what you concluded and what you intend to do differently.

● 2.1 The Six Constructs of Self

The course objectives name four constructs — self-awareness, self-acceptance, self-confidence and self-motivation — and the workshops add self-esteem and self-efficacy. They are used loosely and they are not the same thing. They are also a sequence, not a list: awareness without acceptance produces insight and misery; acceptance without confidence produces comfort and passivity; confidence without motivation produces a start and no continuation; motivation without esteem produces effort without resilience, because the person reads every setback as a

verdict on their worth. Efficacy is the machinery underneath all five — the belief that this particular action can be carried out in this particular situation.

Two deserve a word each. **Self-confidence** is a judgment of capability in a specific domain, held before the performance and based on evidence; its commonest loss is not failure but the belief that one has failed, which is why it grows most reliably out of *repaired* failures. **Self-acceptance** has two halves and people manage only one: acceptance of the given (body, history, aptitudes, temperament) and acceptance of the actual (one's uncomfortable thoughts and impulses, not edited out of awareness). The second is harder and more useful, because an impulse never acknowledged cannot be managed — it simply appears as behaviour.

TABLE 2.1 — THE SIX CONSTRUCTS COMPARED

Construct	Core question it answers	Scope	Develops mainly through	Key caution
Self-awareness	What am I actually experiencing right now?	Present moment	Attention, journal writing, honest feedback	Confusing noticing with judging
Self-acceptance	What in me can I stop fighting?	The whole person	Confronting reality without self-punishment	Acceptance mistaken for resignation
Self-confidence	Can I do <i>this</i> ?	A specific domain	Preparation, repaired failure, seeing peers succeed	Assuming it transfers to every domain
Self-motivation	Why would I keep going when nobody is watching?	Effort over time	Competence, autonomy, a stated purpose	Expecting motivation without any of the three
Self-esteem	Am I a person of worth?	Global	Mastery, dignity, non-shaming feedback, values	Building it on others' approval alone
Self-efficacy	Can I carry out <i>this action</i> in <i>this situation</i> ?	Task-specific	Mastery experiences, role models, credible persuasion, bodily state	Relying on praise rather than on success

● 2.2 Workshop 1 (COMPULSORY) — Understanding Self and SWOT Analysis

This workshop has two parts. The first, **Understanding Self**, is what Section 2.1 prepares you for. The second, **SWOT Analysis**, may be applied personally, institutionally or organisationally, or to any other activity with reference to the functioning of the school — in practice you will do a personal SWOT and one organisational SWOT, most often of the school you are attached to or of a function in it such as the management of mid-day meals or the running of the science period.

SWOT is a general framework for examining any situation. Its logic is a two-by-two. The first axis separates what is **internal** to the unit being examined from what is **external** to it; the second separates what is **helpful** to a stated goal from what is **harmful** to it.

OBJECT	INTERNAL (inside it)	EXTERNAL (outside it)
HELPS the goal	STRENGTHS Habits, skills, resources and attributes that already serve it.	OPPORTUNITIES Openings arising outside, that the unit could use <i>if it were ready.</i>
HARMS the goal	WEAKNESSES Internal gaps that can <i>be changed by the unit itself.</i>	THREATS Pressures from outside that cannot be removed — only prepared for.

First decide the goal. Then place every item — if it cannot be argued over, it does not belong in the box.

Figure 2.1 — The SWOT matrix. Internal items are within reach; external items are not.

Two rules make a SWOT worth doing. First, **name the goal before you start**, because the four boxes are empty without one. “My strengths” is not a SWOT; “for the goal of taking a mixed-ability class of forty through a unit of mathematics without relying on the textbook exercise” is. Second, **only internal things go in Strengths and Weaknesses**. A trait, a resource, a behaviour and a skill are internal. A policy, an examination board, a change in the neighbourhood, a parent’s attitude is external. Students routinely put “good teachers are available” in Opportunities; it belongs in Strengths if it is a feature of the institution, and is more likely a Threat if the teachers are leaving.

Applied to a person, the internal axis covers temperament, habits, knowledge, skills, health, time, emotional state, reputation, and the people and materials at one’s disposal. Applied to a school, it covers the head teacher and staff, the building, the enrolled strength and the profile of the children, the materials and routines, and the internal culture; the external axis covers the Block resource persons, the state and central schemes and their timelines, the examination requirements, the community’s expectations, connectivity, and the demographic situation.

REMEMBER

A SWOT that stops at four lists is a diagnosis, not a plan. Convert it to **TOWS** by matching the internal factors against the external ones: **SO** deploy a strength to seize an opening; **ST** use a strength to reduce a threat; **WO** close a weakness so an opportunity can be used; **WT** remove a weakness or limit the exposure. A personal SWOT must be written for a *stated goal*, never for “my life” or “my career” — the narrower the goal, the more possible it is afterwards to say whether the analysis was correct.

● 2.3 Workshop 2 — Life Skill Education: Meaning, Importance and Mode of Transaction

DEFINITION

Life Skill Education is the planned and purposeful teaching of those abilities that enable a person to understand and manage the self, to make informed decisions, to communicate effectively, to work with others, to cope with stress and conflict, and to respond constructively to the situations of everyday life. It is not the teaching of a subject, but of the abilities the subject syllabus alone does not build.

The syllabus also states that conceptual understanding of LSE must be initiated *before* student-teachers go to the schools for the internship, that they must then practise life-skills activities involving children, and that they must submit reports. The *21st Century Skills Handbook* published through the Manodarpan portal of the Ministry of Education and the *Assam Life Skills Education Framework* are the reference points the syllabus names.

A primary school teaches a child how many sentences there are in a paragraph, and is right to do so. It is equally the school's responsibility to teach that child what to do when two friends quarrel, how to say no to being given something to carry, how to recognise a lie in an advertisement, what to do with rage, and how to ask a teacher for help. Those are learnable abilities, they are not taught by accident, and no subject teacher will teach them in the ordinary course.

The fifteen skills below are the ones most commonly listed in Indian school-level life-skills frameworks. The syllabus does not prescribe a closed list, so treat this as the working repertoire from which you select according to the need you have identified in a class.

TABLE 2.2 — CORE LIFE SKILLS AND THE SIGN THAT A CLASS NEEDS THEM

Life skill	What it means	What it looks like when a child lacks it
Self-awareness	Knowing one's own feelings, thoughts, strengths and effect on others	"It is not my fault" as the reflex answer
Self-motivation	Willingness to begin, continue and finish a task without external pushing	Completes only what is watched; stops when the teacher turns away
Assertiveness	Expressing a need, an opinion or a refusal clearly, without aggression and without submitting	Silent compliance, or pushing others when a want is refused
Empathy	Reading and responding to the feelings of another person	A row continues because nobody sees that a joke landed as cruelty
Coping with emotion	Recognising strong feeling and responding without harm to self or others	Hits, throws objects, refuses to speak, or shuts down
Stress management	Coping with pressure, frustration and difficulty	Distress before an ordinary task; does not return after a scolding
Decision-making	Choosing among alternatives and accepting the consequence	Defers every choice to another child
Problem-solving	Finding a workable way through a situation not seen before	Waits for an answer to a question not asked
Critical thinking	Examining a claim before accepting it — an advertisement, a rumour, a teacher's own word	Repeats whatever is heard, from anyone
Creative thinking	Producing more than one way of doing or seeing a thing	One method is copied, errors with it
Communication	Expressing meaning clearly, and listening so as to receive it	Speaks loudly instead of clearly; does not attend

Life skill	What it means	What it looks like when a child lacks it
Cooperation	Working towards a shared result, sharing the work and the credit	Groups form but nothing is shared
Resilience	Recovering after a setback and returning to the attempt	One error produces withdrawal for the lesson
Leadership	Taking responsibility for a small group's process, with or without a title	Uncontested willingness to lead; nobody else offers
Time management	Organising effort within available time and prioritising	Everything is attempted and nothing is finished

TABLE 2.3 — THE TWO BROAD CATEGORIES OF LIFE SKILLS

Category	Concerned with	Typical skills	School signature
Psychological / emotional (inner or personal skills)	Managing the self — one's thinking, feeling and behaviour	Self-awareness, self-motivation, assertiveness, empathy, coping with emotion, stress management, decision-making, problem-solving, critical and creative thinking, time management	The child who can recognise and regulate feeling, who tries again, who says no without shutting down
Social (interpersonal skills)	Managing relationships — the self in company with others	Communication, cooperation and collaboration, negotiation, social awareness, networking, leadership	The child who negotiates, waits, takes a turn, includes the weakest member, and is trusted with a responsibility

Nearly every life skill is in one of two conditions: a child is managing the *self*, or the child is managing the self in company with others. Once you see that you can diagnose a class quickly. A class in which the recurring problem is escalation — hitting, shouting, refusing — is usually short of **emotional** skills: coping, empathy, assertiveness. A class in which the recurring problem is paralysis — nobody begins, nobody shares, nothing is finished — is usually short of **social** skills: cooperation, communication, time management. The remedy differs, and choosing the wrong one wastes a term.

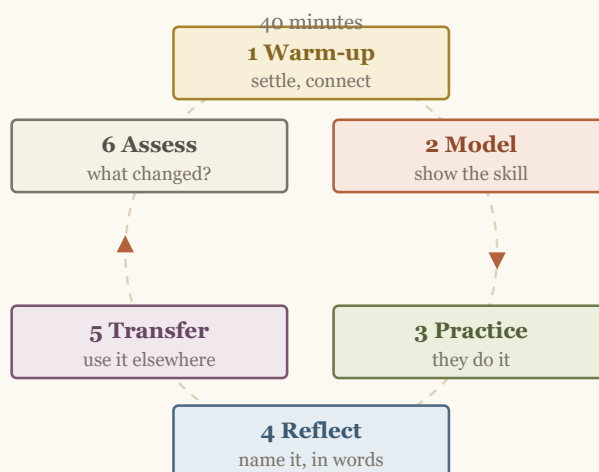
Four reasons make LSE matter: it is **preventive**, since most of what schools later manage as indiscipline or anxiety has roots in skills never taught; it is the **transferable part of learning**, since a child who can lose a game and keep going can also be told that a piece of writing is not good enough yet; it is **central to the Indian curriculum language**, with NEP 2020, NCF-SE 2023 and the *21st Century Skills Handbook* all naming social-emotional and cognitive skills among the priority competencies; and it is the **teacher's own preparation**, since a teacher who has not practised managing their own emotion cannot teach a child to manage it.

Mode of transaction

The distinctive feature of LSE is its **mode**. These are not abilities transmitted by explanation; they are acquired by doing, watching, attempting, failing and talking about what happened. Each of the modes below has a place in a 40-minute session. A life-skills session is emphatically not a lecture on being good, and not a punishment register; both are common in Indian classrooms and both are the opposite of what this course builds.

TABLE 2.4 — MODES OF TRANSACTION IN LIFE SKILL EDUCATION

Mode	How it works and when to use it	Watch for
Discussion	Open talk around a question — “what could Rina have done?” — surfacing the range of responses before the class narrows them	Three children answering; use pair talk first
Role-play	Children act out a short situation containing a dilemma; the class comments	Performers become “the bad one”. Rotate, and never let the label stick
Storytelling	A story carrying one skill — a problem, a choice, a consequence	Ending with a moral the children must spot; ask questions instead
Simulation / games	A structured game in which the skill is needed to play well	A game whose point is to win destroys the point
Group activity	Small groups producing something together, skill built into the task	The strongest child does all of it; build the role in
Field visit / observation	Seeing the skill in the world — a queue, a market, a water point	A visit with no question to answer; give the class a task
Peer mentoring	A more capable child supports a less capable one for a defined task	It becoming unpaid teaching; the mentor needs a task too
Reflective journal	A short entry: what happened, what I did, what I would change	A punishment record; it must be private and ungraded
Demonstration / modelling	The teacher or a child shows the behaviour; the class describes it	Only the teacher demonstrating; the class must produce examples



Stages 1–2 belong to the teacher. Stages 3–4 belong to the children. Skipping 4 is the commonest failure.

Figure 2.2 — The shape of a life-skills session. The reflective stage is where the learning consolidates.

EXAMPLE

A Class IV session on managing anger, 40 minutes. 0–4 min: word-association in pairs — one child names a feeling, the partner names what the body does; collect four on the board without comment. 4–10 min: a local story of two siblings, one refused something and hits the other; stop before the resolution and ask for three alternatives. 10–14 min: model one technique only — the pause of counting to five and putting the hand

down, once badly and once well. 14–24 min: role-play in threes with cards carrying different anger situations, roles rotated every round, the class naming which technique was used.

24–33 min: the class agrees three things a Class IV child can do when angry and scribes them onto a chart displayed for the year — the teacher writes their words, not four of her own. 33–38 min: where else anger shows up — the playground, the tap queue, the bus, home. 38–40 min: everyone writes one private sentence, “When I am angry I will...”; collect nothing and read none aloud, because reading them out destroys the safety that made them honest. Run it twice, a week apart, changing exactly one thing; the second run is where you discover whether the class has moved.

● 2.4 Workshop 3 — Communication Barriers That Hinder Effective Communication

The word *effective* does the important work: communication has occurred when meaning has been transferred, not when words have been sent. A teacher can be fluent, loud, clear and grammatically correct and still fail entirely to communicate, and a shy teacher with poor technique can succeed. The classic transmission account — sender, encoding, channel, decoding, receiver, noise — comes from the Shannon and Weaver tradition.

Its weakness is worth naming: it treats meaning as something packaged and delivered like a parcel. It is not. Meaning is **reconstructed** by the receiver out of that receiver’s own experience, and the remedy is the **field of experience** — the overlap between what sender and receiver know and understand. The more that field overlaps, the more meaning is shared; the less, the more the receiver simply hears words.

DEFINITION

A **communication barrier** is any factor — physical, physiological, psychological, semantic, cultural, organisational or linguistic — that distorts a message, reduces the receiver’s attention to it, or causes the receiver to interpret it differently from the sender’s intention. It is a property of the situation, not of the speaker, which is why the same explanation can be clear to one person and unintelligible to another in the same room.

TABLE 2.5 — COMMUNICATION BARRIERS, WITH EXAMPLE AND REMEDY

Barrier type	What it is, and an example	What a teacher can do
Physical / environmental	Distance, noise, poor light, heat, overcrowding, an echoing room — a forty-child Class IV lesson in a room built for twenty; the children at the back are seen to be misbehaving when they simply cannot hear	Move to a verandah or open space; group in a circle rather than rows; use a whistle instead of the voice; check that every child can see the demonstration
Physiological	Impairment of hearing, sight or speech; sound and fatigue effects on the receiver — a child with a mild hearing difficulty asked to follow an oral instruction	Seat the child where the sound is direct; reduce ambient noise; give visual support; allow repetition without embarrassment
Psychological	Emotion, stress, fatigue, fear, distrust, or a pre-existing opinion about the speaker — a child asked a question in front of forty peers after being laughed at yesterday stops answering; the barrier is the memory, not the question	Ask private questions privately; let the child answer by writing or to a partner first; name the fear before asking again

Barrier type	What it is, and an example	What a teacher can do
Semantic	Faults in the message: ambiguity, double meanings, jargon, unfamiliar figures of speech, tone contradicting the words — “complete the test” heard as “finish the whole test”	Say it twice in two different ways; use the child’s own words back; replace a label about a person with a statement about a task
Organisational / cultural	Rules, hierarchy, custom and group norms determining what may be said, to whom and how — a child who will not contradict an elder; a parent who cannot speak to the head teacher directly	Learn the local conventions first; create a channel that does not require a person to overstep rank; raise concerns through a group
Language	Difference between the language of instruction, the home language and the peer group’s language — a child who understands EVS fully in the home language but not the glossary in the school language	Permit the home language for discussion; teach the school-language terms as terms; have the child teach one concept to a peer in the home language first

Active listening and the 3H technique

Almost every barrier above is reduced by one thing: the willingness and capacity to **listen** before responding. **Active listening** is not agreement and not silence; it is the deliberate effort to reconstruct the speaker’s meaning, check that reconstruction, and only then respond. Its observable components are facing the speaker, allowing silence, asking open questions, reflecting back, paraphrasing and summarising. A widely used teaching device in Indian teacher-training material is the **3H technique** — *Head, Heart, Hand*.

A message may be head-received (understood: I know what was said), heart-received (felt: I take it seriously, and I understand the feeling behind it), and hand-received (acted upon: something is actually done). A message can stop at any of the three, and each stopping point is a different failure. “Your drawing is untidy” is head-received and nowhere else, and usually stops the drawing; agreement without change is the commonest outcome with school administrators. Indian teacher-training resources use several closely related listening frameworks with different acronym expansions; the 3H sequence is used here because it is simple, teachable, and maps directly onto the three failure modes.

Worked case. A Class III child’s father tells the teacher at the gate that the child is being beaten at home, and asks that nothing be said to the mother. The barrier is organisational and cultural — the relationship between family and school, and the convention that family matters are not the school’s business. The head-received failure is registering the words but not the fear. The heart-received response is asking what the child says at home, and asking again what the father wants to happen now. The hand-received response is deciding what action follows, including referral to the child protection mechanisms and the school-based child protection committee studied in S1.1. The first part is a communication task, the second a professional and ethical one, and they cannot be separated.

● 2.5 Workshop 4 — Professional Ethics and Accountability of Teachers

These two are taught together because in teaching the second is what gives the first teeth. A teacher with strong ethical commitments who is never answerable to anyone is ethical in intention only; a teacher who is closely supervised but has never reflected on what is right is compliant, not professional. A **profession** is a

group holding specialised knowledge, bound to a code of conduct, accountable to a community of practice rather than to one employer, and accepting a duty to keep competence current — all four are present in teaching.

A **professional teacher** is one who meets that standard in practice, and note the word *effect*: a teacher can be technically correct, punctual and even liked and still cause harm through shaming, through ridicule of a child's home language, through public comparison of children, or through silence about a child in distress.

DEFINITION

Professional ethics is the set of principles governing professional conduct — the standards of behaviour a person is expected to meet *because of* the role they hold, not merely because of law or convenience.

Professional accountability is the fact of being answerable, to identified parties, for the discharge of that role, which implies their right to know, to question and to require correction.

In India the reference point is the **Teacher Professional Code of Ethics** issued by the **National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE)**, the statutory body established under the **NCTE Act, 1993**. NCTE also notifies a **Professional Ethics Committee**, the body through which matters of professional ethics are considered. The Code is organised around the dignity of the profession, then around the teacher's dealings with learners, the school, parents and guardians, colleagues and staff, and the community.

TABLE 2.6 — THE SCOPE OF THE TEACHER PROFESSIONAL CODE OF ETHICS

Area	What is expected of the teacher, and why it is in a code
Dignity of the profession	Conduct that sustains the standing of teaching — because the school's reputation is the sum of thousands of individual acts of conduct, most of them never observed
Professional competence	Keeping knowledge and skill current, and meeting the demands of the role — because children cannot evaluate the quality of what is taught into them
Dealing with learners	Dignity, non-discrimination, absence of physical and mental harm, safeguarding — because children cannot leave, cannot complain, and depend entirely on the adult
Dealing with the school	Meeting obligations, following the decisions of the institution, protecting its reputation — because institutional trust makes collective work possible
Dealing with parents	Respectful, honest and confidential communication — because the school holds a great deal of information about a family
Dealing with colleagues	Professional courtesy; no belittling; support rather than competition — because children model themselves on every relationship they see in the school
Dealing with the community	Conduct that reflects well on the school — because the school is a public institution in a small community

Ethical dilemmas in the classroom

A dilemma arises when two obligations are genuinely in conflict, so that whichever course is taken one value is partly violated. Nine recur often enough to be worth rehearsing in advance, because rehearsing them is the purpose of this workshop.

1. **Favouritism.** Extra attention to a child whose family is helpful to the school, at the cost of the others. The pull is social and practical; the obligation is procedural fairness.
2. **Reporting a colleague.** A senior colleague has been persistently harsh to a class. Reporting protects the children and damages a relationship — and a school in which no one reports anything protects no one.
3. **Confidentiality.** A child discloses something painful. The teacher is bound to act, and the child assumed the conversation was private. The conflict cannot be dissolved, only handled honestly, with the child's knowledge wherever possible.
4. **Discipline and punishment.** Corporal punishment is prohibited, and the genuine problem of a class that will not attend to instruction is not solved by removing the one available instrument. The answer is a system of consequence, consistency and restoration.
5. **The teacher's own child.** A relative is in the class. Full neutrality towards one's own family is difficult; the workable answer is usually to disclose the relationship and agree in advance who handles difficult moments.
6. **Language and identity.** A child is corrected harshly for using the home language in a class where almost everyone uses it. Efficiency and the child's dignity are in conflict.
7. **Gifts and favour.** A small gift is ordinary courtesy in some communities; in a code, accepting anything that could be read as influencing assessment is a risk. What is required is a declared, consistent, transparent rule.
8. **Use of children for personal errands.** Routine and almost universal in many schools, and a clear use of institutional resources for private purposes.
9. **Photography and sharing of children's images.** A photograph posted without consent is a disclosure, and children cannot withdraw from it. This is now also a matter of law in India, and in any case a matter of dignity.

Accountability runs in six directions, and only the first is obvious. A teacher is accountable to **learners** for their learning, safety, dignity and fair treatment; to **the school** for preparation, record-keeping, the timetable and the institution's reputation; to **parents** for honest information and family confidentiality; to **the community** for being a credible public institution; to **oneself** for honesty about one's own competence, including admitting error and asking for help before a child is failed; and to **the profession** for not lowering its standards by one's own practice.

The honest difficulty in each case is worth naming: compliance with the institution can itself become unethical if the institution is wrong; community expectation can be contradictory and can press the teacher against a child's interest; and accountability to oneself is the one nobody else will check, so it is the one that decays first.

EXAM FOCUS

A viva question on this workshop is likely to be a scenario question rather than a definition. Prepare an answer in three parts for each of the nine dilemmas: what the obligations are, which is stronger and why, and what I would actually do on Monday morning. The third part is the one that is assessed.

● 2.6 Workshop 5 — Meaning of Self, Factors Impacting Self-Development, and the Johari Window

Meaning of self

Three different things get called “the self” in ordinary speech. **The self as identity** — “who I am”: a relatively stable collection of beliefs and self-descriptions through which a person interprets experience; it can be examined, because it consists in part of assigned meanings, and meanings can be revised. **The self as self-concept** — “how I see myself”: not a fact but a judgement, held in head and body, formed from experience and constantly updated; a hypothesis about oneself, not a report of oneself.

The self as self-image — “how I appear to others”: inseparable in practice from the first two, because a person is not always aware of the gap between how they are and how they come across, and much of the ordinary distress of teaching arises from that gap. Because the self is a set of meanings rather than a fixed thing, it can be developed: self-development is not the accumulation of credentials, but the deliberate revision of the meanings one holds about oneself and the deliberate widening of the evidence one allows to enter them.

Factors that impact self-development

1. **Internal.** Age and stage; temperament; the quality of early attachment; physical health and disability; mental habits such as perfectionism, rumination and avoidance; the accuracy of self-perception; and how success and failure are attributed — to circumstances, to others, or to one’s own controllable action.
2. **Family and social.** The family’s style of expressing approval or criticism; comparison with others; the emotional climate of the home; the influence of the wider kin group; and the presence or absence of at least one adult who took the person seriously.
3. **Peer and school.** Whether the school rewarded effort or only performance; ranking and public comparison; the teacher’s attitude to mistakes; sport, art and group activity; and the school’s overall climate of dignity or of shame.
4. **Cultural and social context.** Family expectation, community reputation and the multiple demands on a woman’s and a man’s time alike; the multilingual classroom; and the economic situation of the family, which shapes both opportunity and self-expectation.
5. **Professional.** The school’s culture; the head teacher’s style; the availability of mentoring; the possibility of practice-teaching with feedback; the demands of the internship; and institutional pressure to conform.
6. **Situational and life.** Health, bereavement, relationship change, financial strain, examination seasons, and the particular stage of the D.El.Ed. year in which a self-assessment is done.

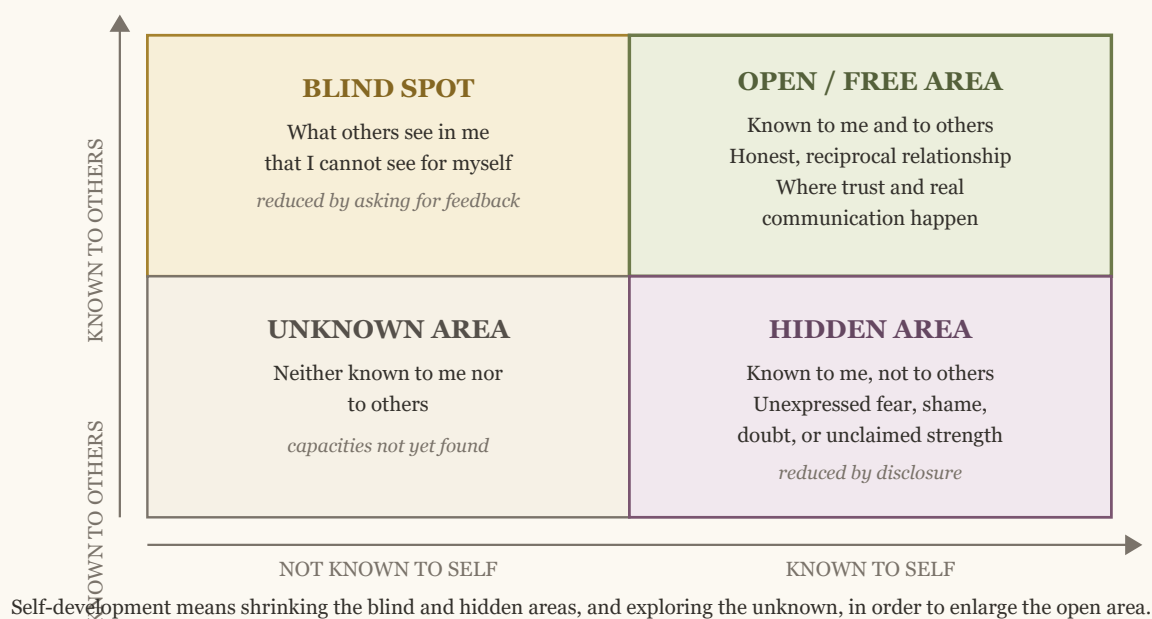


Figure 2.3 — The Johari Window. The open area is not a fixed trait; it changes with every conversation.

The **Johari Window** (from Joseph Luft and Harrington Ingold) is the most usable instrument in this paper, because it converts the vague instruction “know yourself” into two specific and quite different jobs: *learning what others see*, and *deciding what to show*. The **open area** is known to oneself and to others — the region of accurate mutual understanding where trust and real communication are possible, and where a teaching relationship feels effortless because little has to be explained or defended. The **blind spot** is known to others and unknown to oneself: the effect one has on a room that one cannot see.

It shrinks only by asking other people, and by believing what they say — which is exactly where Writing Task 6 operates. The **hidden area** is known to oneself and unknown to others — the fear before the demonstration lesson, the shame after a poor result, and also capacities one has never claimed; it shrinks by disclosure, to the right person, in an appropriate setting. The **unknown area** is known to neither oneself nor others — potential not yet discovered by anyone; it shrinks through experience, new situations and honest exposure to one’s limits.

TABLE 2.7 — A JOHARI WINDOW REFLECTION, COMPLETED FOR YOURSELF

Pane	Write three specific entries	How it shrinks
Open	Three things colleagues and children would agree describe you	Maintained by honesty and by not performing
Blind	Three things others have told you that you did not know — from a mentor, a peer, a child, a parent	By asking specific questions: “what should I stop doing?” “when have I lost you?”
Hidden	Three things you feel and have never told anyone in this programme	By disclosure to one trusted person, and by refusing to use them as explanations in a situation
Unknown	Three things you have never tried and do not know whether you can do	By trying one, in a small and recoverable way, and recording the result honestly

Worked example. A student-teacher who has never received specific feedback records the blind pane as: “I did not know I interrupt; I only knew that some children stopped talking.” Two colleagues are asked one question — “when I am explaining something, what do I do that is unhelpful?” — and both answer the same thing independently. That single convergence converts a guess into knowledge, and the open area grows.

A teacher working on the hidden pane might record “I am afraid in front of the head teacher, and I have arranged to avoid the demonstration class”; the growth comes from doing the demonstration anyway, with a colleague in the room. The model transfers to children directly: apply the window to a child who has stopped speaking in class, ask what each pane would contain, and give the one action that would most enlarge that child’s open area.

● 2.7 Workshop 6 — Practising Mindfulness and Meditation for Harmonious Relations

Note the verb: *practice*, not study. This workshop cannot be run as a talk; it has to be done in the room, and the doing is the assessment.

DEFINITION

Mindfulness is the quality of attention in which a person is present with what is happening now, without rushing to judge, approve or reject it — a *quality of attention*, cultivable inside or outside any formal practice.

Meditation is a *family of structured practices* for training that attention, such as attending repeatedly to the breath, to bodily sensation or to sound, and noticing when attention has wandered and returning it.

Mindfulness is what meditation is for.

Mindfulness and meditation have deep origins in several religious and contemplative traditions, and it is important to be accurate about that rather than either denying it or collapsing the traditions into a technique. In this course they are used in the **secular, academic** sense: as attention-training practices that can be taught in a public school without belonging to any religion. **Religious practice** is undertaken within a tradition, on its own terms, for the ends that the tradition defines; its value cannot be reduced to its technique, and it should neither be required of a child nor dismissed.

Secular mindfulness is used as a *psychological skill*, the way physical education uses running: the running is not religious, the benefit is real, and the person teaching it is not claiming to be a religious authority. In your classroom, teach the practice; do not teach the doctrine; and never require a child to take part in a practice belonging to a tradition their family does not belong to.

TABLE 2.8 — FOUR THINGS EASILY CONFUSED WITH MINDFULNESS

Practice	What it is	How it differs from mindfulness	What it is good for
Mindfulness	Present, non-judging attention	It is the quality itself	Noticing before reacting; listening; coping
Meditation	Structured practice for training attention	One method of cultivating the quality	Regularity; settling a busy or anxious mind
Religious practice	Acts of devotion or discipline within a tradition	Has a theological content that secular use neither claims nor replaces	Meaning, belonging, a life of faith
Relaxation exercise	Techniques deliberately producing physical calm	Aims to reduce arousal; mindfulness also involves noticing what is present, including what is uncomfortable	Sleep, physical tension, acute anxiety before an event

Simple secular practices, to teach and to practise

- ▶ **The three-minute breathing space.** Sitting, attending to the breath and the body, noticing when attention has gone elsewhere and bringing it back. The return of attention is the practice, not the staying.
- ▶ **STOP.** A four-step sequence for the moment of pressure: **S**–top, pause; **T**–ake a slow breath; **O**–bserve what is happening inside and outside; **P**–roceed with a chosen action rather than a reactive one. The most teachable form, because it takes four seconds and applies in a corridor.
- ▶ **Mindful listening, three minutes.** The teacher reads a short passage; children listen with eyes closed and raise a hand when they notice their own mind wandering. Discovering how often attention leaves is itself the lesson.
- ▶ **The body scan for children.** Attention moved slowly from the crown of the head to the feet, noticing hands, shoulders, tummy — places where a class holds its tension. Four or five minutes, in silence.
- ▶ **Mindful movement.** Walking slowly across the room, feeling the foot lift, move and land. Useful with older primary children, and a good bridge to the yoga component of S1.8.
- ▶ **Noticing three things.** At the end of the day or session, naming three things that went well and one difficulty met and handled — a deliberate corrective to the habit of noticing only what went wrong.

The strongest argument for these practices in an elementary school is not relaxation. A class taught by a person managing their own attention is a class in which children are taught how to manage theirs, and most of what is called “restlessness” in a primary class is a difficulty of attention rather than a moral defect. Two cautions: do not present these practices as cures. They are associated with improved attention, better emotional regulation and less reactivity, and those associations are what you may honestly describe; they are not treatment for illness, they do not promise examination results, and they do not substitute for referral, for a proper rest break, or for a conversation with a colleague about a workload that is genuinely beyond a person.

● 2.8 How Workshops and Seminars Are Conducted

The syllabus sets out the points to be highlighted while seminars and workshops are conducted. They govern the format of every session, so a student-teacher who has seen them applied knows exactly what is expected in a presentation.

TABLE 2.9 — THE POINTS TO BE HIGHLIGHTED IN CONDUCTING A SEMINAR OR WORKSHOP

Point	What it means in practice	What a student-teacher should do in response
Objective formulation	The session begins from a stated objective — what participants are expected to be able to do or think at the end, not what the speaker intends to cover	Read the objective before the session; at the end, test yourself against it rather than against how much was said
Display of a film or CD, or reading of a text	An audio-visual or written stimulus opens the session, so that discussion begins from a shared experience rather than from opinion alone	Watch or read it beforehand; come with two observations, not one
Small-group discussion	The work is done in small groups, so that every voice is used and the larger group is not carried by three speakers	Take a role in the group; the person who writes should also be the person who reports back
Debate and discussion	A position is argued against another, and the disagreement is productive rather than personal	State your position in one sentence early; concede a valid point aloud
Extempore speech	Speaking without preparation, on the spot, on a theme drawn from the session	Take a turn even if unprepared; structure it as position, example, conclusion

UNIT 2 QUICK REVIEW

KEY POINTS

- ▶ The first workshop is compulsory; two more are chosen; each carries 5 marks; the unit totals 15. Marks come from reports reflecting critical thinking, not from attendance.
- ▶ Six constructs — awareness, acceptance, confidence, motivation, esteem, efficacy — are a sequence, not a list.
- ▶ A SWOT needs a stated goal. Strengths and Weaknesses are internal; Opportunities and Threats external. TOWS turns the diagnosis into a plan.
- ▶ Life skills divide into psychological/emotional (managing the self) and social (managing the self in company with others).
- ▶ Conceptual understanding of LSE must be built *before* the internship; the internship is where it is practised with children.
- ▶ Words are not meaning. Meaning is reconstructed inside the field of experience shared by sender and receiver.
- ▶ Six barrier types: physical/environmental, physiological, psychological, semantic, organisational/cultural, language.
- ▶ Johari Window: open area, blind spot, hidden area, unknown area. Shrink three to grow one.
- ▶ Mindfulness is a quality of attention; meditation trains it. Teach the practice, never the doctrine, and never require a child to participate.

KEY TERMS

Self-awareness · Self-acceptance · Self-confidence · Self-motivation · Self-esteem · Self-efficacy · SWOT · TOWS · Life Skill Education · Mode of transaction · Field of experience · Noise · Semantic barrier · Active listening · 3H technique · Professional ethics · Professional accountability · NCTE Teacher Professional Code of Ethics · Johari Window · Mindfulness · Meditation

Seminar — Any Two ($2 \times 5 = 10$)

Four seminar themes are listed and two are chosen. Each carries 5 marks, awarded on the basis of the report in which the student-teacher reflects on their own critical thinking. A seminar is assessed as a piece of thinking, not as attendance, and a seminar report that summarises a discussion scores nothing. What each theme asks is the same question asked from a different direction: *what in my own practice stands between me and this?*

● 3.1 Seminar 1 — Nurturing Humane Qualities

Humane qualities are dispositions, not skills: compassion, empathy, respect, kindness, humility, honesty, patience and a concern for the dignity of other people. They are dispositions because they cannot be acquired by instruction; they are built by the situations one is repeatedly placed in and by what those situations reward. What makes this a seminar rather than a topic is that the group has to locate the moments in ordinary teaching where these qualities are actually tested — and the honest answer is uncomfortable. It is the moment a child repeats a mistake for the fourth time; the moment a colleague is unfair to a weaker teacher in a staff meeting; the moment a parent's complaint is defensible and cannot be met.

- ▶ **Empathy versus sympathy.** Empathy is understanding another person's experience as that person experiences it; sympathy is feeling sorry from one's own position. Sympathy can become distance; empathy is the basis of good response.
- ▶ **The dignity clause.** Being treated as a person is a condition for learning, not a reward for good behaviour. A child who is shamed stops learning before the content is reached.
- ▶ **Humility is functional.** It is what makes a teacher able to be corrected, and therefore able to improve.
- ▶ **Integrity under low supervision.** What a teacher does when no register is marked and no inspector is present is the useful test of humane qualities — not the practice the test expects, but the practice that is convenient.

Seminar method: case vignettes read aloud, discussed in small groups, then each group asked what the quality in question would actually *cost* the teacher. If the answer is "nothing", the group has chosen the wrong vignette.

● 3.2 Seminar 2 — Managing Emotion

Emotion is not the problem. Unmanaged emotion is. This seminar treats managing emotion as a sequence: **notice** it in the body before it becomes a judgement, **name** it precisely, **understand** what it is about, **choose** a response rather than reacting, and only then **act**. Almost every failure at the last two steps is a failure at the first. The teacher who does not notice the rising heat cannot choose, and can only react.

- ▶ **Triggers are personal and often predictable.** A colleague's public correction, a child's defiance in front of others, a long untended queue. Knowing one's own list is the first practical outcome of this seminar.
- ▶ **The narrow window.** Under rising arousal, the range of responses a person can choose from narrows. The function of a pause is not to be calm but to widen that range back before answering.

- ▶ **Rumination is not processing.** Processing ends in a decision or a release; rumination is a circular loop of blame with no exit, and it looks like serious thought while producing none.
- ▶ **Other people's emotion is data.** Emotion in a class is information about the situation and about the person, not an obstacle to instruction — and suppressing the display of it without addressing the cause simply relocates the problem.
- ▶ **Sequences worth building:** STOP from Workshop 6; the pause and the naming; the technique of writing the emotion out in one unedited paragraph before replying to anything difficult.

Seminar method: participants describe one real incident of lost control; the group analyses what the emotion was, what preceded it, and what a different first move could have been. Plenary closes with each participant naming one private trigger and one agreed response for it.

● 3.3 Seminar 3 — Inculcating Soft Skills and Social Grace

Soft skills are the learnable abilities through which a person works with others and manages their own working life — listening, speaking, cooperation, self-management, problem-solving, decision-making and, increasingly, the digital skills covered in the internship. **Social grace** is the courteous and workable form these take in company: greeting, waiting one's turn, not interrupting, saying no without shaming, thanking, apologising, entering and leaving a shared space without collision. Its basis is **respect for the other's dignity and autonomy**. Grace that enforces one group's habits on another, or that punishes a child for what the home language calls polite, is not grace.

- ▶ **Soft skills are teachable; virtues are not.** "Wait your turn" can be modelled, rehearsed and rewarded. "Be kind" can only be exemplified.
- ▶ **Grace cuts across language.** A child who greets a teacher with folded hands, a child who greets with *namaskar*, a child who simply looks up and nods — all are acknowledging. Insisting on one form penalises a home language and the families who use it.
- ▶ **Grace among equals.** What is taught must extend to the weakest child, to the mute child, to the newest child and to the cleaning staff of the school. Grace that is selective is status, not grace.
- ▶ **Digital conduct.** Sharing photographs, forwarding messages and group membership are now part of a child's social life, and the school's rules about them should be discussed with children, not merely imposed on them.

Seminar method: the group lists the ten courtesies a Class I child actually needs, then asks which of them the current class routine practises and which it quietly punishes. The usual finding is that a noisy, active class is praised for speed and punished for grace, and that reversing that is cheap.

● 3.4 Seminar 4 — Negotiating Self-Criticism and Self-Validation for Self-Esteem

This seminar handles the two voices everyone has. One is the **inner critic**, which evaluates by comparison and by character — "you are not a good teacher," "you are not that sort of person" — and which produces shame. The other is the **inner coach**, which evaluates by action — "that lesson moved too fast for the back three rows; tomorrow try the demonstration before the explanation" — and which produces improvement. Shame makes a person avoid the evidence; a coach makes

a person go and look at it. That single difference is why self-criticism, which sounds like a virtue, can hold a person at a fixed level of performance.

TABLE 3.1 — NEGOTIATION TABLE FOR THE SELF-CRITICISM SEMINAR

Self-critical statement	Coach's re-statement	What the re-statement makes possible
"I am a failure as a teacher."	"That lesson did not reach the back three rows. Here is what I will change on Monday."	A specific change, a test of it, and a repeat
"They all think I am incompetent."	"Two of them asked me to repeat it; the rest said nothing, which tells me less than I assume."	Checking a belief instead of obeying it
"I should be able to do this without thinking."	"Expert teaching uses routines built by deliberate practice, not by absence of thought."	Planning as competence rather than as failure
"I failed the class, so I failed myself."	"Twenty-two of forty reached the objective; three need a second attempt on Thursday."	Partial data, and a plan that follows from it
"If they criticise me I am nothing."	"One person's judgement is information about their frame, and possibly about my work — both are worth checking."	Taking feedback without being consumed by it

Self-validation is the deliberate provision of evidence to oneself, so that self-esteem does not depend entirely on who else happens to be present. Its sources are **realistic** rather than inflated: the record of work actually done, progress actually made, promises actually kept, feedback actually received and acted on. Low self-esteem and high self-esteem share the same defect from opposite ends — both are unstable under ordinary contact with evidence, because both depend on something outside the person. Validation is the internalisation of that evidence.

● 3.5 Seminar Selection and Reporting

TABLE 3.2 — CHOOSING BETWEEN TWO SEMINARS

Seminar	Choose it if your recent difficulty is...	Its one-line test at the end
Humane qualities	Reacting to children or colleagues in a way you cannot afterwards defend	Can you name the moment the quality would have cost you something, and what you did?
Managing emotion	Losing control under pressure, or carrying a feeling that will not settle	Can you name your three triggers and the agreed response for each?
Soft skills and social grace	A class where courtesy is treated as decoration and conflict is treated as noise	Which courtesies does your actual class routine practise, and which does it punish?
Self-criticism and self-validation	Unable to take criticism, or unable to stop criticising yourself	Can you say what is true, what is your story, and what you will do on Monday?

A seminar report runs to three parts and no more: what the theme made me notice that I had not noticed; what I would have to give up to act on it; and the one small change I am making this month, with the date by which I will know whether it worked. Write the middle part honestly. A report that claims to have resolved a difficulty the writer still has is the commonest failure in this unit, and it is also the easiest to detect.

UNIT 3 QUICK REVIEW

KEY POINTS

- ▶ Four seminar themes; two chosen; 5 marks each; the unit totals 10. Marks come from the reflective report, not from attendance.
- ▶ Humane qualities are dispositions built by what a situation rewards — test them by their cost.
- ▶ Managing emotion is notice → name → understand → choose → act. Failure at choosing is usually failure at noticing.
- ▶ Rumination is not processing; it is circular blame without an exit.
- ▶ Social grace rests on respect for the other's dignity, and must not enforce one language group's habits on another.
- ▶ The inner critic evaluates by character and produces shame; the inner coach evaluates by action and produces improvement.
- ▶ Self-validation means supplying oneself with realistic evidence, so that esteem does not depend on who else is present.

KEY TERMS

Humane qualities · Empathy · Sympathy · Dignity · Integrity · Trigger · Window of tolerance · Rumination · Soft skills · Social grace · Inner critic · Inner coach · Shame vs guilt · Self-validation · Realistic self-esteem

SCHOOL INTERNSHIP PROGRAMME

Life-Skills Activities with School Children

The SIP component of this paper requires the student-teacher, during the school internship, to conduct life-skills activities with school children and to submit a report on them. It is the point at which the whole paper stops being a report about oneself and becomes a report about what happened in a classroom. Nothing new is taught here: the six constructs, the fifteen life skills, the nine modes of transaction and the six-stage shape of a session have all been prepared in the preceding pages.

TABLE 4.1 — THE SIP TASK, STEP BY STEP

Step	What to do	What to record
1. Diagnose	Sit in on two or three ordinary periods of a class you will work with. Note one recurring difficulty, not a dramatic one — escalation, silence, non-finishing, turn-taking	Class, date, period, the difficulty in one sentence, and one quotation of what actually happened
2. Select	Choose the <i>one</i> life skill that addresses that difficulty. More than one skill in a forty-minute session with children who have never done this before guarantees that none of it lands	The skill, and the reasoning from observed behaviour to selected skill in three or four sentences
3. Plan	Write the six stages — warm-up, model, practice, reflect, transfer, assess — with minutes against each, and the mode of transaction for each stage. Decide what you will change if only one thing survives	The plan, and the fallback if the class will not participate

Step	What to do	What to record
4. Prepare	Arrange materials, a space that is not rows-and-desks, and permission. Tell the class teacher what you are doing and why; tell the children only that something different is going to happen	Materials list, time and place agreed
5. Conduct	Run the session. Keep to the plan for the first two stages; after that, follow the class. Expect to be wrong about the time	Actual minutes at each stage against planned; two things that did not go as intended
6. Repeat	Run a second session with one change only. A single session proves nothing about the class; the comparison is the evidence	What you changed and the difference you observed
7. Report	Write the report below. Evidence and reflection; not a lesson plan and not a summary of the syllabus	The report, with dates and the class teacher's remark if obtainable

REFLECTION

The report is at its best when it is uncomfortable. “The children enjoyed it” and “the activity was successful” carry no information. The lines that earn marks are the observational ones — by the third round the argument had stopped; a child who had not spoken in a week spoke once and then withdrew again; I had underestimated how long permission to speak takes — followed by the decision those observations forced. Write what you saw, then what you will do differently, then why you will do it.

Precautions. Do not conduct a life-skills session as a substitute for the subject periods you are attached to, and do not make a child's participation in it a condition of anything. Never use the session to discipline, to name children publicly, or to correct academic errors — the moment a session is used as punishment it teaches the opposite of what it is for. Do not record individual children by name or photograph them without permission. Keep the activity short: two sessions, not ten, and the second one matters more than the first.

INTERNAL ASSESSMENT

Assessment Pattern — 50 Marks, Entirely Internal

There is no external examination paper in this subject. All 50 marks are awarded internally, across the three units and the internship component described above.

TABLE 5.1 — INTERNAL ASSESSMENT STRUCTURE

Component	Requirement	Marks
Unit 1 — Writing Tasks	Any five of the ten tasks; the mentor distributes the topics; a report or an article is submitted for each	15
Unit 2 — Workshop	The first workshop compulsory, plus any two; a report in which the student-teacher reflects on their own critical thinking	15
Unit 3 — Seminar	Any two of the four themes; a reflective report on each	10
SIP	Life-skills activities conducted with school children during the internship, plus a report on them	10
Total		50 — all internal

COMMON MISTAKE

The total of the three units is 40 (15 + 15 + 10), not 50. The syllabus specifies 50 internal marks for the paper but does not name the remaining 10 as a separate component; the SIP component — life-skills activities with school children and a report on them, listed in this subject's syllabus and also carried in SI-I — accounts for exactly 10, which is why it is shown in the table above. This reading is inferred, not stated: if your institution's notification or the mentor's instruction allocates those 10 marks differently, follow the institution. What must not be done is to present a 40-mark structure as the full scheme, or to add a component the syllabus never mentions.

Because assessment is internal, the standard applied is the standard of the report, not of the examination hall. Unit 1 is marked on what was written and on whether it shows the writer's own thinking; Unit 2 on the reflection on critical thinking the workshop was designed to elicit; Unit 3 on the same basis. Nothing in this subject rewards a student for describing what self-understanding is in general, and everything in it rewards a student for describing what it looks like in one specific classroom, on one specific day, with evidence.

QUICK REVISION

Quick Subject Revision — A Memory Sheet

TABLE 6.1 — THE WHOLE PAPER ON ONE PAGE

Component	Requirement	Marks	What is assessed
Unit 1 — Writing Tasks	Any 5 of 10; mentor distributes	15	Content, evidence, and whether it shows your own thinking
Unit 2 — Workshop	Workshop 1 compulsory + any 2 of 6	15	Reflection on your own critical thinking
Unit 3 — Seminar	Any 2 of 4	10	Reflection on your own critical thinking
SIP	Life-skills activities with school children + report	10	Observation and the decision it forced
Total	Entirely internal — no written paper	50	—

TABLE 6.2 — UNIT 2 AT A GLANCE: NINE ITEMS YOU MUST BE ABLE TO REPRODUCE

Item	Count	The items themselves
Six constructs	6	Self-awareness · self-acceptance · self-confidence · self-motivation · self-esteem · self-efficacy
SWOT → TOWS matches	4	SO (strength + opportunity) · ST (strength + threat) · WO (weakness + opportunity) · WT (weakness + threat)
Life skills	15	Psychological/emotional (10): self-awareness, self-motivation, assertiveness, empathy, coping with emotion, stress management, decision-making, problem-solving, critical thinking, creative thinking, time management — social (5): communication, cooperation, negotiation, social awareness, networking, leadership
Modes of transaction	9	Discussion · role-play · storytelling · simulation/games · group activity · field visit/observation · peer mentoring · reflective journal · demonstration/modelling
Communication barriers	6	Physical/environmental · physiological · psychological · semantic · organisational/cultural · language

Item	Count	The items themselves
Accountability is owed to	6	Learners · the school · parents · the community · oneself · the profession
Ethical dilemmas	9	Favouritism · reporting a colleague · confidentiality · discipline and punishment · one’s own child · language and identity · gifts and favour · children used for errands · photographing children
Johari Window panes	4	Open area · blind spot · hidden area · unknown area
Session stages	6	Warm-up · model · practice · reflect · transfer · assess

TABLE 6.3 — NAMES, DATES AND DOCUMENTS		
Name or item	Date	Why it is here
Srimanta Sankardeva	1445–1568	Central figure of the Assamese Vaishnavite tradition; <i>Giti Giti</i> ; <i>Borgeet</i>
Madhav Kandali	14th century, first half	Earliest major Assamese translator; Assamese <i>Ramayana</i>
Madhavdeva	1484–1564	Most influential verse; <i>Borgeet</i> still sung
Srimanta Chaitanya Deva	16th century	The six <i>kantas</i>
Chandraprabha Saonian	Early 17th century	<i>Kirtan Ghosa</i>
G. Sankara Kurup	1861–1941; Nagaon school 1883	First Assamese-medium school; persistence against obstruction
NCTE and the NCTE Act, 1993	1993	Statutory body; issues the Teacher Professional Code of Ethics and notifies the Professional Ethics Committee
Luft and Ingold	—	Johari Window
Shannon and Weaver	—	The transmission model of communication, and its field of experience
NEP 2020 · NCF-SE 2023	2020 · 2023	Social-emotional and cognitive skills named among priority competencies
<i>21st Century Skills Handbook</i> ; Manodarpan, Ministry of Education	—	LSE reference point named by the syllabus

REVISION AID

Important Differences

TABLE 7.1 — THE COMPARISONS STUDENTS MOST OFTEN CONFUSE		
A	B	The distinction
Self-awareness	Self-acceptance	Awareness is knowing what is happening; acceptance is deciding not to fight it. Awareness can lead to misery, acceptance to action
Self-confidence	Self-esteem	Confidence is a judgment of capability in a domain, held before performance; esteem is a global sense of being worth something. Confidence can be high in one subject and absent in the next
Self-esteem	Self-efficacy	Efficacy is task-specific (“can I do this?”); esteem is global (“am I worth something?”). Efficacy builds mastery; esteem builds dignity

A	B	The distinction
SWOT	TOWS	SWOT diagnoses by placing items in four boxes; TOWS acts, by matching internal factors against external ones into strategies (SO, ST, WO, WT)
Psychological / emotional skills	Social skills	The first manage the self; the second manage the self in company with others. Escalation points to the first, paralysis to the second
Transmission model	Field of experience	The model explains how a message travels; the field of experience explains whether meaning arrives. Overlap of experience, not volume of voice, decides success
Professional ethics	Professional accountability	Ethics is what is right; accountability is being answerable to identified parties for doing it. Ethics without accountability is intention only
Self-concept	Self-image	Concept is how I see myself; image is how I appear to others. Most teaching distress comes from the gap between the two
Shame	Guilt	Guilt is about an action and can be repaired; shame is about the person and makes a person avoid the evidence. Shame is what stops a teacher looking at the evidence
Inner critic	Inner coach	The critic evaluates character and produces shame; the coach evaluates action and produces improvement
Empathy	Sympathy	Empathy enters the other's experience; sympathy remains in one's own and can become distance
Mindfulness	Meditation	Mindfulness is the quality of present, non-judging attention; meditation is one family of practices for training it
Workshop	Seminar	A workshop is constructed around a task done; a seminar around a theme discussed. Both are assessed on the reflective report
Soft skill	Social grace	A soft skill is the ability; social grace is the courteous form it takes between people, resting on respect for the other's dignity

BACK MATTER

Course Information

● Course Objectives

The syllabus states six objectives. Every writing task, workshop and seminar in the three units is a way of serving one of them.

TABLE 8.1 — THE SIX COURSE OBJECTIVES AND WHERE THEY ARE PRACTISED

Objective	Where it is practised
Develop communication skills and ways to establish peace and harmony within oneself and with society	Writing Tasks 2 and 4; Workshop 3 and 6; Seminar 2
Facilitate personal growth and social skills amongst student-teachers	All three units; SIP life-skills sessions
Enhance self-awareness, self-acceptance, self-confidence and self-motivation for personal development as well as professional growth	Section 2.1; Writing Tasks 1–8; Workshop 1 and 5
Help student-teachers inculcate values to enhance their personalities	Writing Task 2 (scripts for role-play); Seminar 1
Motivate student-teachers towards quality teaching-learning processes	Writing Task 10; Seminar 1 and 4; Workshop 1 (institutional SWOT)

Objective	Where it is practised
Develop capacity to apply a professional attitude and deliberation skill	Workshop 4; Seminar 3; review of every writing task

● Mode of Transaction

The syllabus states that the nature of the course is practical, in the form of writing, workshop and seminar, and that it is to be exclusively monitored and evaluated at the respective Teacher Education Institute. It is designed so that student-teachers assimilate and internalise the situations they are placed in rather than memorising descriptions of them. Concretely, the course is transacted through:

- ▶ **Workshops and seminars** conducted with contextualised material and formats, prepared by the mentor and the faculty team.
- ▶ **Various types of writing tasks** — creative writing, article writing, script writing, case study and introspective report — submitted across the semester.
- ▶ **Monthly journal writing**, which is a continuous reflective practice rather than a single submission.
- ▶ **Group discussion, sharing and interaction** with experts, faculties and mentors.
- ▶ **Audio-visual devices** — film, CD, documentary, or the reading of a text — used to open a seminar or workshop before discussion begins.
- ▶ **Interactive sessions**, group discussion, role play and presentation inside the workshop and seminar format.
- ▶ **School internship and visits**, including a visit to a meditation centre or spiritual development centre in the local area, which the syllabus notes may provide an additional opportunity for understanding the self.

● Assessment Structure

50 marks, all internal: Unit 1 (15) + Unit 2 (15) + Unit 3 (10) + SIP (10). There is no written end-semester paper. The full pattern is set out in Table 5.1, and the honest note about the derivation of the 10 SIP marks is in the Internal Assessment section.

BACK MATTER

Suggested Readings

TABLE 9.1 — SUGGESTED READINGS

Reference	Use it for
SCERT Assam, <i>D.El.Ed. (PSTE) Revised Curriculum-Syllabus 2024</i> , the S1.4 paper	The tasks, workshops, seminars, SIP requirement and assessment pattern, exactly as specified
Ministry of Education, <i>21st Century Skills Handbook</i> (available through the Manodarpan portal)	Life-skill content for Unit 2 and the SIP session
<i>Assam Life Skills Education Framework</i> , SCERT Assam	The local framing of life-skills work in the school
NCTE, <i>Teacher Professional Code of Ethics</i> ; <i>NCTE Act, 1993</i>	Workshop 4 — professional ethics and accountability
Luft, J. and Ingold, H., <i>Managing Human Relations</i>	The Johari Window in Workshop 5
Shannon, C. E. and Weaver, W., <i>A Mathematical Theory of Communication</i>	The transmission model and the field of experience in Workshop 3
NEP 2020; <i>NCF for School Education 2023</i>	Social-emotional and cognitive skills as curriculum priorities
Any one standard textbook on Educational Psychology	The constructs of self, attribution, and self-concept behind Units 1–2
Any one standard textbook on Educational Philosophy	The values and humane-qualities material in Seminars 1 and 3

End of S1.4, Towards Self-Understanding. All units of this paper are assessed internally; there is no written end-semester examination.